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VISUAL DESIGN GUIDELINES · V1.0

White first. Type does *the work.*

The complete system behind the portfolio: principles, colour, typography, layout, components, data visualisation, templates and content rules.

OCTOBER 2026 · FOR DESIGNERS AND DEVELOPERS BUILDING OR EXTENDING THE SITE

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01 / PRINCIPLES

Five rules. *Every decision.*

The site exists to let a hiring manager, recruiter or founder understand what Anurag does, in seconds, and to go deeper only if they choose. Every rule below serves that.

01 White first

White (#FFFFFF) is the page. Colour and black are accents, used sparingly so they carry weight when they appear.

02 One idea per surface

Each tile, section and page makes one point. If a block needs two headlines, split it. Depth lives one click away, never on the homepage.

03 Type does the work

Hierarchy comes from scale, weight and the sans/serif contrast — not from boxes, borders or decoration.

04 Colour carries meaning

Red means problem, risk or the chosen option. Green means improvement. Ink and greys are baselines and structure. Never use a colour just to decorate.

05 Every number is honest

Show targets that were missed, label judgement-based charts as judgement, and never combine rates measured on different bases into one chart.

02 / COLOUR

Mostly white. *Colour with a job.*

Nine core colours and four tints. Proportions on any page should stay roughly at **80% white, 12% surface grey, 6% ink, 2% red/green**.

Core palette

Paper
#FFFFFF
Page background. Always.

Surface
#F5F5F3
Tiles, cards, panels, chart tracks.

Ink
#121212
Headlines, body emphasis, rules, dark anchor tiles, baseline bars.

Graphite
#4A4A47
Body text, leads, descriptions.

Press red
#D62B2B
Accent: kickers, labels, problem data, chosen option, key word in pulls.

Deep red
#B01E1E
Red used as text on white or on red tint (AA).

Signal green
#12855F
Improvement fills: bars, top borders, nodes.

Deep green
#0E6B4C
Green used as text: result numbers, labels.

Supporting greys and tints

Stone
#8A8A86
Second half of two-tone headlines (large type only), neutral options

Note grey
#6B6B68
Chart notes and honesty labels.

Rule
#E6E6E3
Section dividers, table lines, bar tracks.

Backdrop
#F3F3F0
The giant background word only.

Red tint
#FDECEC
Background of the chosen option / key insight box.

Green tint
#EAF5EF
Background of result cards (optional).

Soft red
#FF8A8A
Red on black tiles only (kickers on dark case tile).

Mid grey
#CFCFCB
Inactive bars, before-values, icon fills.

02 / COLOUR · CONTRAST & MEANING

Readable *at every size.*

FOREGROUND	BACKGROUND	RATIO	USE	WCAG
#121212	#FFFFFF	18.7:1	All text	AAA
#4A4A47	#FFFFFF	8.9:1	Body, leads	AAA
#4A4A47	#F5F5F3	8.1:1	Body inside tiles	AAA
#D62B2B	#FFFFFF	5.0:1	Labels, kickers, numbers 24px+	AA
#B01E1E	#FFFFFF	6.9:1	Red text at any size	AA
#B01E1E	#FDECEC	6.0:1	Text in chosen-option box	AA
#0E6B4C	#FFFFFF	6.5:1	Green text at any size	AA
#0E6B4C	#EAF5EF	5.8:1	Text in result cards	AA
#8A8A86	#FFFFFF	3.5:1	Headline second half — 24px+ only	AA large
#6B6B68	#FFFFFF	5.3:1	Chart notes (11px+)	AA
#FFFFFF	#121212	18.7:1	Text on ink tiles	AAA
#FFFFFF	#D62B2B	5.0:1	White on red (bold 16px+ only)	AA
#FF8A8A	#121212	8.3:1	Soft red on ink	AAA

Colour meaning

COLOUR	MEANS	EXAMPLES
Red #D62B2B	Problem, risk, failure — or the option that was chosen. Also the brand accent.	47% OTP failure; 15 incidents; “C · Hybrid — chosen”; section labels; key word in pull statements
Green #12855F / #0E6B4C	Improvement, outcome, “after”.	70→91%; 118–146K; the “SCALE” roadmap step; result numbers
Ink #121212	Structure, baseline, neutral data, primary actions.	Rules above stats; neutral bars; primary buttons; dark anchor tiles
Greys	Context, alternatives not chosen, secondary text.	Options A and B; “before” columns; chart notes

Rules. Never use red and green as the only difference between two data series — always pair with a label or position. Never place red text below 16px on red tint. Never introduce a new hue; if a chart needs a fourth series, use ink and greys.

03 / TYPOGRAPHY

Three families. *Three jobs.*

All three are free on Google Fonts. Load with `display=swap` and always declare fallbacks.

Instrument Sans

Voice. Headlines, body, numbers, buttons. Weights 400, 500, 600, 700.

`'Instrument Sans', 'Helvetica Neue', Arial, sans-serif`

Instrument Serif Italic

Emphasis. The second half of headlines, pull statements, hindsight lines, “why” notes. Italic 400 only.

`'Instrument Serif', Georgia, serif`

JetBrains Mono

Metadata. Section labels, kickers, stat labels, chart axes and notes. 400, 500, 600.

`'JetBrains Mono', monospace`

The signature move: the two-tone headline

Three options. *One call.*

A bold Instrument Sans statement, then a short Instrument Serif Italic completion in Stone #8A8A86, one space apart, same size. The sans half states the fact; the serif half lands the point. Keep the whole headline under ~8 words. Optionally colour the serif half red when it names the problem.

The pull statement

Retraining first would have fixed the wrong thing.

One per page section group, never two in a row. Serif italic, max 22 characters per line-width (22ch), key phrase in Press red.

03 / TYPOGRAPHY · SCALE

Fluid sizes. *Min, scale, max.*

Every size uses CSS `clamp(min, preferred, max)` so type grows on large screens instead of leaving empty space. Values below are exactly what the site uses.

Homepage

ROLE	FAMILY / WEIGHT	SIZE (CLAMP)	LINE HEIGHT	TRACKING	NOTES
Home hero H1	Sans 700	`clamp(38px, 5vw, 96px)`	1.02	-0.035em	Max width min(1200px, 72vw)
Hero lead	Sans 400	`clamp(17px, 1.4vw, 26px)`	1.55	0	Graphite; max 46ch
Section heading	Sans 700	`clamp(28px, 2.8vw, 52px)`	1.1	-0.025em	“How I work”, “Case studies”
Skill tile title	Sans 700	`clamp(22px, 1.6vw, 30px)`	1.2	-0.015em	
Skill tile line	Sans 400	`clamp(15px, 1vw, 19px)`	1.45	0	Graphite
Case tile title	Sans 700	`clamp(26px, 2vw, 40px)`	1.12	-0.02em	
Kicker	Mono 500	13px	1.4	0	Press red
Tile number	Mono 400	12px	1.4	0	#5C5C5C
Nav / header	Sans 500	`clamp(15px, 1vw, 18px)`	1.4	0	Name in Sans 700, 18px

Skill pages and case studies

ROLE	FAMILY / WEIGHT	SIZE (CLAMP)	LINE HEIGHT	TRACKING	NOTES
Background word	Sans 700	`clamp(110px, 21vw, 420px)`	0.8	-0.06em	Backdrop #F3F3F0; one per page
Skill H1	Sans 700	`clamp(52px, 7vw, 140px)`	0.95	-0.045em	
Case study H1	Sans 700	`clamp(44px, 6vw, 120px)`	0.98	-0.045em	Max 18ch
Hero tagline	Sans 400	`clamp(19px, 1.7vw, 30px)`	1.45	0	Graphite; max 40ch
Section label	Mono 600	12px	1.4	0.08em	UPPERCASE, red, “01 / Title”
H2 (two-tone)	Sans 700 + Serif It.	`clamp(34px, 4.2vw, 80px)`	1.02	-0.035em	Serif half -0.01em
Lead	Sans 400	`clamp(18px, 1.5vw, 26px)`	1.55	0	Max 46ch; one bold phrase
Big stat number	Sans 700	`clamp(48px, 5.6vw, 112px)`	0.95	-0.045em	Ink, red or green
Stat label	Mono 400	12px	1.5	0.04em	UPPERCASE, Graphite
Pull statement	Serif Italic	`clamp(32px, 4.2vw, 84px)`	1.1	-0.01em	Max 22ch
Hindsight line	Serif Italic	`clamp(28px, 3.2vw, 64px)`	1.1	0	Inside Surface panel
Card title	Sans 700	`clamp(20px, 1.6vw, 30px)`	1.15	-0.02em	

ROLE	FAMILY / WEIGHT	SIZE (CLAMP)	LINE HEIGHT	TRACKING	NOTES
Card body	Sans 400	`clamp(15px, 1.05vw, 19px)`	`1.5`	`0`	Graphite
Numbered-list number	Sans 700	`clamp(36px, 4vw, 72px)`	`0.9`	`-0.04em`	Red or ink
Chart note	Mono 400	`11px`	`1.4`	`0`	UPPERCASE, #6B6B68

Measure. Body copy never exceeds 46 characters per line on wide screens (max-width: 46ch). Headlines are not width-limited except case-study H1 (18ch) and pull statements (22ch).

04 / LAYOUT & GRID

Wide pages. *Narrow lines.*

Containers stretch on big screens; text stays readable because of the character-based measure.

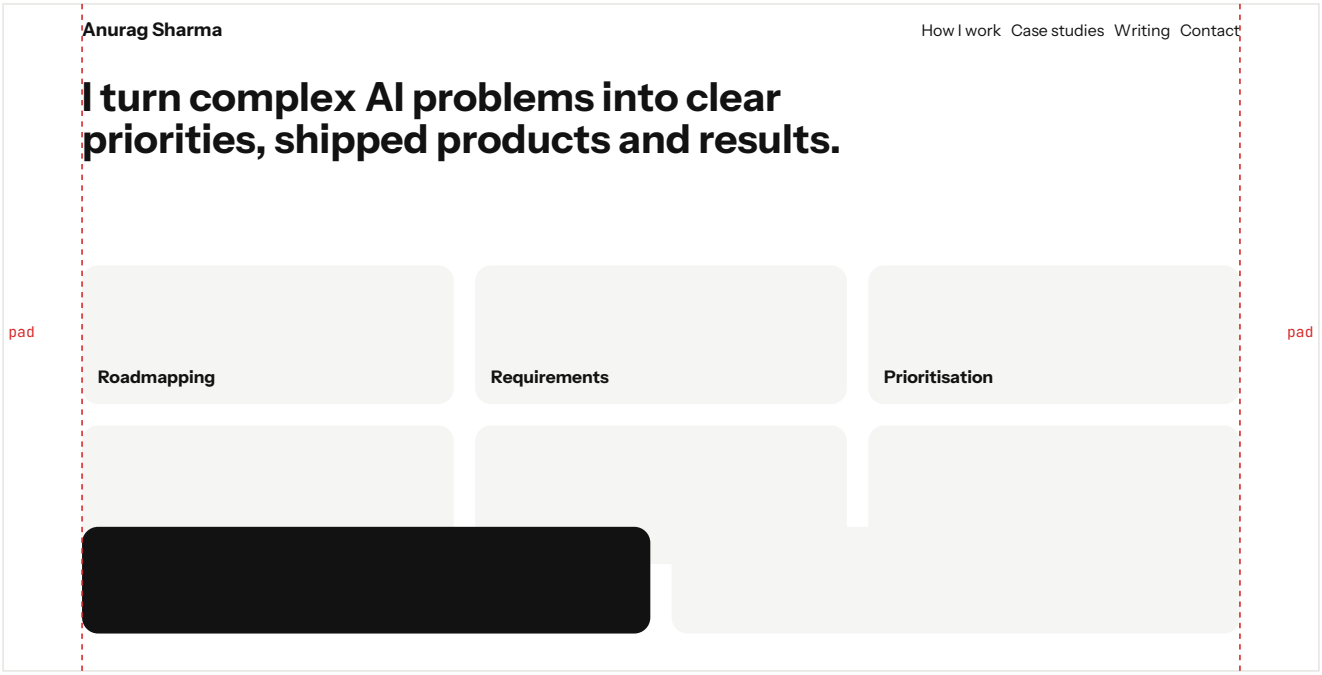
ELEMENT	VALUE	NOTES
Homepage container	`max-width: 1760px`	Centred
Skill & case container	`max-width: 1560px`	Centred
Side padding	`clamp(20px, 5vw, 112px)`	All pages
Home hero padding	`clamp(48px, 8vw, 160px) top, clamp(48px, 7vw, 128px) bottom`	
Inner hero padding	`clamp(56px, 8vw, 104–128px) top`	Skill / case
Section padding	`clamp(64px, 6vw, 128px) vertical`	Each section has a 1px #E6E6E3 top rule
Home section spacing	`padding-bottom: clamp(96px, 7vw, 160px)`	
Header	`padding clamp(20px, 2vw, 40px) 0`	Name left, links right

Grids and breakpoints

GRID	DESKTOP	BELOW 1000PX	BELOW 980PX	BELOW 760PX	BELOW 640PX
Home skill tiles	3 columns	3	2	2	1
Home case tiles	2 columns	2	2	2	1
Case key stats (grid4)	4 columns	2	2	1	1
Stats / cards (grid3)	3 columns	3	3	1	1
Two-up (grid2)	2 columns	2	2	1	1

Gaps: home grids clamp(16px, 1.4vw, 28px); stat rows 28px; card grids 16–20px; result grid 32px.

Homepage wireframe



05 / SPACING, SHAPE & LINES

Soft corners. *Hard rules.*

TOKEN	VALUE	USE
space-1	4px	Icon gaps, chip internals
space-2	8px	Chip gaps, tight stacks
space-3	12–14px	Label to headline, stat number to label
space-4	18–22px	Headline to lead, lead to visual inside cards
space-5	28–40px	Lead to visual; grid gaps for stats
space-6	56px	Results to hindsight panel
section	clamp(64px, 6vw, 128px)	Between sections

SHAPE	RADIUS	USE
Home tiles	22–24px	Skill tiles, case tiles
Cards & panels	20–22px	Option cards, squads, hindsight panel
Inner blocks	12–16px	Readers, squads inside panels, pipeline nodes
Bars	4–8px	Chart bars (half the bar height for tracks)
Pills	999px	Buttons, chips, nav CTA

LINE	SPEC	USE
Section rule	1px #E6E6E3	Top of every section and list row
Stat rule	2px #121212	Above every big stat and reader
Card accent	4–5px top border	Colour = meaning (red / ink / green / stone)
Dashed	1.5px dashed #8A8A86	Parallel or optional work (e.g. “In parallel” lane)
Axis	2px #121212	Chart axes and baselines

No shadows except the soft halo on the chosen data point (0 0 0 6–8px rgba(214,43,43,0.15)). **No gradients.** No borders around tiles; separation comes from the Surface fill.

06 / COMPONENTS

The building *blocks.*

Every page is assembled from these. Do not invent new components without adding them here.

COMPONENT	SPECIFICATION
Header	Red 10px dot + name (Sans 700, 18px) left; text links right (Sans 500). On inner pages the right side is a single back link (“← All skills”).
Home hero	Mono kicker in red → H1 (max 3 lines) → one Graphite line of scale. No buttons, no image.
Skill tile	Surface fill, radius 22px, min-height clamp(280px, 20vw, 400px). Order: mono number (top) → abstract mini-graphic → title → one line → “See how →”. Whole tile is the link.
Mini-graphic	A wordless, 30–60px tall abstraction of the skill’s main chart (sequence blocks, PRD + lines, dots, bars, org, funnel). Uses red for the key element, Mid grey for the rest.
Case tile	Primary case on Ink with white text and Soft-red kicker; secondary on Surface. Title Sans 700 clamp(26px, 2vw, 40px). “Read →” at the bottom.
Background word	One uppercase word per inner page (ORDER, SPEC, CHOOSE, LEAK, SQUADS, MEASURE, TRUST, AGENTS) in Backdrop #F3F3F0, right-aligned behind the hero, aria-hidden.
Section label	Mono 600, 12px, uppercase, 0.08em, red: “NN / TITLE”. Always the first element of a section.
Two-tone H2	See Typography. Every section has one.
Lead	One or two sentences, max 46ch, exactly one bold phrase in Ink 600.
Big stat	2px Ink rule on top → number → mono uppercase label. In rows of 2–4. Colour only if it means something.
Pull statement	Full-width section with only a serif-italic sentence (key phrase red) and an optional Graphite sub-line.
Card	Surface fill, radius 20px, 4px top border in a meaning colour, mono tag → title → body. Chosen variant: Red-tint fill, 2px red border, “· CHOSEN” in the tag.
Numbered list	Rows separated by 1px rules: large number (red for problems, ink for lessons) in a fixed column, title + one sentence.
Result block	“□ / The result” label → two giant green numbers with Graphite labels → Surface panel with “In hindsight” mono label and a serif-italic line.
Chips	Pill, Surface fill, Sans 600 13–16px. Used for “Skills shown” links on case studies.
Primary button	Ink pill, white Sans 600 15px, min-height 52px, padding 0 24px.
Text link	Sans 600, Ink, arrow suffix “→”; hover turns Press red.
Footer	Email (Sans 600, 18px) left; LinkedIn, GitHub, Résumé right; 1px top rule.

06 / COMPONENTS · ASSEMBLED

How they *stack.*

A typical skill-page section at reduced scale: label → two-tone H2 → lead → cards → big stats → hindsight panel.

02 / THE OPTIONS

Three options. *One call.*

Each was reasonable. They differed in how fast they'd help

A	B	C · CHOSEN
Retrain the model	**Redesign flows**	**Hybrid**

70→91%	118–146K	47%
INTENT ACCURACY	CONTAINED CALLS / MONTH	FAILED AT OTP

IN HINDSIGHT

Next time, I'd fix measurement in week one.

07 / DATA VISUALISATION

Charts that *tell the truth.*

Charts are built in HTML/CSS (no chart library) so they scale with type and inherit the palette. Every chart answers one question, stated in the headline above it.

CHART	WHEN TO USE	SPEC
Horizontal bar	Rates or shares that each have their own base (47% OTP, 23% dead-ends)	Track #E6E6E3 14px high, radius 7px; value in Sans 700 28px right-aligned; key bar red, others ink; note “Each rate measured on its own base”
Before / after column	A single metric that improved (70% → 91%)	Two columns on a 2px ink baseline; before Mid grey, after green; mono labels
Funnel	Sequential stages of one journey	Centred or right-aligned bars of decreasing width, ink → greys → green → red for the final outcome; question or label beside each stage in serif italic
Option map	Qualitative trade-off between options	2px ink axes, dashed quadrant lines, grey dots for rejected options, a 24–28px red dot with halo for the chosen one; note “Chart positions are a judgement, not measurements”
Waves / Gantt	Parallel delivery over time	Rows on Surface tracks, ink bars; parallel tracks as 10px lines in red/green/stone; month ticks in mono 11px
Incident / count bars	Counts by category	Rows with label, bar, and count in Sans 700; largest category red
Distribution	Forecast uncertainty (P50/P75/P90)	24 thin bars on ink baseline; P50 red, P75/P90 ink, others Mid grey; labels below; note when the shape is illustrative
Stacked bar	Composition of a whole (81 tests)	One bar, radius 10px; segments ink / grey / red; big numbers below each segment
Flow / pipeline	Systems and handoffs	Ink nodes with white text, grey arrows; downstream outputs in green

Honesty rules

RULE	WHY
Never use a pie chart for numbers that don’t add to 100%.	The original site’s failure chart mixed three different bases.
Show missed targets next to results (e.g. 118–146K vs an 800K target).	A reader will do the maths anyway; owning it signals judgement.
Label judgement-based or illustrative charts in a mono note.	Distinguishes data from opinion.
Don’t invent precision: use ranges (118–146K) and “~” where the source does.	Matches the source material.
Every number on the site must trace to a case study.	Keeps the homepage, skill pages and case studies consistent.

08 / PAGE TEMPLATES

Three page types. *One rhythm.*

Homepage

ORDER	BLOCK	CONTENT RULE
1	Header	Name + How I work, Case studies, Writing, Contact
2	Hero	Kicker, one-sentence H1, one scale line. Nothing else.
3	How I work	Heading + 6 skill tiles (3 × 2). No sub-copy.
4	Case studies	2 tiles: banking (Ink), six-agent (Surface)
5	Footer	Email + links

Skill page

ORDER	BLOCK	CONTENT RULE
1	Hero	Background word, “How I work · NN”, skill name as H1, one-sentence tagline
2	01 / The situation	Two-tone H2, lead, 3 big stats
3	Pull statement	Optional; the turning point in one sentence
4	02 / The core section	The one visual that proves the skill (roadmap, spec, options, funnel…)
5	03 / Supporting section	Optional second visual
6	The result	Two green numbers + “In hindsight” panel
7	Next	“Read the full case study” button + “Next: skill →”

Case study

ORDER	BLOCK	CONTENT RULE
1	Hero	Background word, kicker, H1 (max 18ch), tagline, mono meta line, “Skills shown” chips linking to skill pages
2	Key stats	4 big stats including the honest target comparison
3	Numbered sections	01 → NN, each: label, two-tone H2, lead, one visual
4	Pull statements	Between section groups, never consecutive
5	What went wrong	Numbered list with red numbers + supporting chart
6	What we built	Grid of green big stats with one-line explanations
7	In hindsight	Numbered list with ink numbers
8	Closing pull + next	Final pull statement, back link, next case study button

09 / CONTENT & VOICE

Short, specific, *honest.*

WRITE	AVOID
Outcome-focused, team-aware claims: “I turn complex AI problems into clear priorities, shipped products and measurable results.”	Unilateral or defensive claims: “I decide what to build… then prove it moved the metric.”
Plain statements of scale: “Led a banking voicebot handling 100K+ calls a day.”	“Most recently…”, “currently looking for…”, “open to roles”
Concrete nouns and numbers: “47% of callers failed at OTP.”	Adjectives without evidence: “highly impactful”, “world-class”
Labelled paraphrase: “Paraphrased stakeholder reaction”.	Quote marks around words nobody said verbatim, unlabelled
Plain words for jargon on first use: “intent accuracy (SLU)”.	Unexplained acronyms in headlines (CUG, POA, ARSIM)
Self-explanatory UI: the tiles say “See how →”.	Instructional filler: “Six skills. Each one opens a short page…”

Headline formula

[Fact in 2–4 words.] [Point in 2–4 words, serif italic.] — e.g. “Everyone blamed the AI.”, “30 use cases. Each built from scratch.”, “Specialists, not a generalist.” Reading only the headlines down a page should tell the whole story.

Numbers

Use numerals for all data. Keep the source’s units and ranges (lakh where the case study uses lakh; “~4M”). Use “→” for change (70→91%). Put the unit or meaning in the mono label, not the number.

10 / RESPONSIVE & ACCESSIBLE

Big screens. *Small screens. Everyone.*

AREA	RULE
Fluid scaling	All type, padding, gaps and tile heights use clamp(); nothing stops scaling at laptop width. Containers grow to 1560–1760px.
Readable measure	Body and leads max 46ch; taglines 40ch; pull statements 22ch.
Mobile	All grids collapse to one column by 640–760px; charts keep labels outside bars; the option map keeps a minimum width of 300px.
Touch targets	Buttons min-height 44–52px; whole tiles and cards are links.
Contrast	Body text at AA or better (see Colour). Stone #8A8A86 only for 24px+ headline halves.
Semantics	One H1 per page; H2 per section; charts have role="img" with an aria-label summarising the data; background words and mini-graphics are aria-hidden.
Colour independence	Chosen options also carry “CHOSEN” text; problem bars also carry values and labels.
Motion	None required. If added later: data draws once on scroll (600ms ease-out) and respects prefers-reduced-motion.

11 / DESIGN TOKENS

Build from *these.*

Drop these into the site's global stylesheet and reference them instead of raw values.

```
:root {
  /* colour */
  --paper: #FFFFFF;     --surface: #F5F5F3;   --ink: #121212;
  --graphite: #4A4A47;  --stone: #8A8A86;     --note: #6B6B68;
  --rule: #E6E6E3;      --backdrop: #F3F3F0;  --mid: #CFCFCB;
  --red: #D62B2B;       --red-deep: #B01E1E;  --red-tint: #FDECEC;  --red-soft: #FF8A8A;
  --green: #12855F;     --green-deep: #0E6B4C; --green-tint: #EAF5EF;

  /* type families */
  --sans:  'Instrument Sans', 'Helvetica Neue', Arial, sans-serif;
  --serif: 'Instrument Serif', Georgia, serif;
  --mono:  'JetBrains Mono', monospace;

  /* type scale */
  --t-home-h1:  clamp(38px, 5vw, 96px);
  --t-skill-h1: clamp(52px, 7vw, 140px);
  --t-case-h1:  clamp(44px, 6vw, 120px);
  --t-h2:       clamp(34px, 4.2vw, 80px);
  --t-lead:     clamp(18px, 1.5vw, 26px);
  --t-stat:     clamp(48px, 5.6vw, 112px);
  --t-pull:     clamp(32px, 4.2vw, 84px);
  --t-hind:     clamp(28px, 3.2vw, 64px);
  --t-card-h:   clamp(20px, 1.6vw, 30px);
  --t-card-b:   clamp(15px, 1.05vw, 19px);
  --t-label:    12px;  /* mono, uppercase, 0.08em */

  /* layout */
  --w-home: 1760px;  --w-inner: 1560px;
  --pad-x: clamp(20px, 5vw, 112px);
  --pad-section: clamp(64px, 6vw, 128px);
  --measure: 46ch;

  /* shape */
  --r-tile: 22px; --r-card: 20px; --r-inner: 14px; --r-pill: 999px;
}
```

Font loading

```
<link href="https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Instrument+Sans:wght@400;500;600;700&family=Instrument+Serif:ital@0;1&family=JetBrains+Mono:wght@400;500;600&display=swap" rel="stylesheet">
```